

LittleReads

The Boy Who Befriended Numbers

Education

Ages 7–9

by LittleReads Editorial Team

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Why did the contractor not get the contract? The contractor had especially
the network he started to move.

Chapter 1: The Number That Spoke

First, the number 1 stood up on the page and stretched.

"Finally!" said 1. "Someone is paying attention to us!"

Jide rubbed his eyes. He must be dreaming.

"You are not dreaming," said 7, who also stood up. 7 was tall and mysterious, wearing a scarf. "We have been on this page for three hours. We were bored."

"Numbers can talk?" said Jide.

"Numbers do many things," said 1. "We are the foundation of everything. Without us, you could not count your fingers, tell the time, or buy anything at the market."

Jide had never thought of it that way.

Chapter 2: The Numbers' Stories

Each number told Jide its story.

5 was adventurous. "I am the number of fingers on a hand, the number of senses, the number of points on a star! I am everywhere!"

3 was creative. "I am the number of primary colours. Without me, you would not have purple, green, or orange!"

And then there was 0. Zero was small and quiet, sitting in the corner of the page.

"What is your story?" Jide asked 0 gently.

0 smiled. "I am the most important number of all. Without me, 10 is just 1. And 100 is just 1. I give numbers their power. I am the beginning of possibility."

Jide thought about this. 0 was not nothing — 0 was the start of everything.

Chapter 3: Patterns Everywhere

The numbers showed Jide something he had never noticed before: patterns.

"Look out the window," said 2. "Count the leaves on that branch."

Jide counted: 2, 4, 6, 8, 10.

"Even numbers!" he said.

"Now count the petals on the flower," said 3.

3, 6, 9, 12.

"Patterns!" said Jide, excited. "The world is full of patterns!"

"Of course it is," said 7. "Maths is not about memorising. It is about seeing. Once you see the patterns, everything becomes a puzzle. And puzzles are fun."

Chapter 4: Maths in Real Life

The next day, Jide saw numbers everywhere.

At the market, he calculated how much change his mother should get from the trader.

"Mama, you should get 150 naira back!"

His mother checked. "That is exactly right! How did you know?"

Jide smiled. "I have friends who helped me."

On the way home, he counted the tiles on the pavement. He noticed the pattern: blue, white, blue, white.

He saw numbers in the clock, in the bus number, in the house numbers along the street.

Maths was not boring at all. He had just never looked at it the right way before.

Chapter 5: A New Beginning

That night, Jide opened his homework book and smiled.

The numbers were not moving anymore, but he could almost hear them whispering.

He picked up his pencil and started solving problems. This time, it was not a chore. It was a puzzle. And Jide loved puzzles.

When he finished, he looked at his work and felt proud.

"Thank you," he whispered to the page.

And if you looked very closely, you might have seen the number 1 wink.

From that day on, Jide never said he hated maths again. He said, "I am still learning." And there is a big, beautiful difference between the two.

What We Learned

- Numbers are everywhere and form the foundation of everyday life.
- Maths is about seeing patterns, not just memorising formulas.
- Zero is not nothing — it gives other numbers their value.
- A growth mindset makes learning easier and more enjoyable.

Discussion Questions

1. Can you find numbers and patterns in your daily life?
2. Which number from the story do you like best? Why?
3. How does it feel when you change from "I cannot" to "I am still learning"?

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Thank you for reading!

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